The Past Perfect

💡 **Big idea:** We use the **past perfect** (had + past participle) to talk about something that happened **before** another event in the past: *After they had eaten their breakfast, they looked in their guidebook.*

🎯 **I will learn:** Form the past perfect | Use it to show which past action happened first | Stress the past perfect correctly

📖 Key words

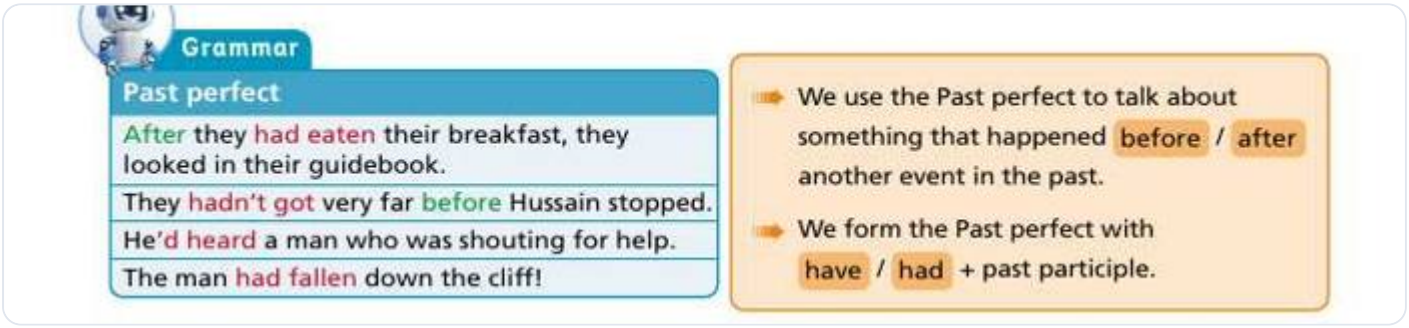
past participle التصريف الثالث للفعل	**before** قبل	**after** بعد
guidebook دليل سياحي	**event** حدث	

Form

- **had + past participle**
- had eaten, had got, had heard, had fallen
- negative: hadn't got
- short form: He'd heard = He had heard

Use

- For an action that happened **before** another past action
- After they had eaten their breakfast, they looked in their guidebook
- They hadn't got very far before Hussain stopped
- The man had fallen down the cliff



Grammar table: past perfect

✏️ Examples

After Muneera ___ (eat) breakfast, she went hiking.

Answer: After Muneera had eaten breakfast, she went hiking.

When we arrived, the bus ___ (leave).

Answer: When we arrived, the bus had left.

🧩 **Activity:** Look at your day yesterday and say six sentences with the past perfect: After I had finished my homework, I...

✅ Check yourself

1. How do we form the past perfect?
2. What does He'd heard mean?
3. Which action happens first?

Answers: (1) had + past participle ، (2) He had heard ، (3) the one in the past perfect